

DATA DICTIONARY

Project: Retail Order Management & Refund Process Improvement
Document: Data Dictionary
Version: 1.0

A. PURPOSE

This document defines the key data fields required for the proposed retail order, return, and refund reporting solution.

It provides a common understanding of what each field represents and how it is used in reporting.

B. ORDER DATA

Field	Description	Example
Order ID	Unique identifier for an order	ORD10025
Customer ID	Identifier of the customer	CUST501
Order Date	Date the order was placed	10-Jul-2026
Product	Product purchased	Laptop
Order Status	Current order status	Pending
Order Amount	Total value of the order	₹45,000

C. SHIPMENT DATA

Field	Description	Example
Order ID	Related order identifier	ORD10025
Shipment Date	Date order was dispatched	11-Jul-2026
Delivery Date	Date order was delivered	14-Jul-2026
Shipment Status	Current shipment status	Delivered
Delivery Status	Delivery outcome	Completed

D. RETURN DATA

Field	Description	Example
Return ID	Unique return identifier	RET20015
Order ID	Related order identifier	ORD10025
Return Date	Date return was requested	16-Jul-2026
Return Reason	Reason for return	Damaged Product
Return Status	Current return status	Pending

E. REFUND DATA

Field	Description	Example
Refund ID	Unique refund identifier	REF30018
Order ID	Related order identifier	ORD10025
Refund Amount	Amount to be refunded	₹45,000
Refund Date	Date refund was processed	18-Jul-2026
Refund Status	Current refund status	Completed

F. REPORTING FIELDS

Field	Purpose
Processing Time	Measures time taken to complete a process
Return Rate	Measures percentage of orders returned
Refund Rate	Measures percentage of orders refunded
Pending Orders	Identifies orders requiring action
Pending Refunds	Identifies refunds requiring action

G. DATA RELATIONSHIPS

The core entities are connected through the **Order ID**.

CUSTOMER

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ORDER

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+-----> SHIPMENT

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+-----> RETURN

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REFUND

This relationship allows users to trace an individual transaction through the complete order lifecycle.

H. DATA QUALITY RULES

The following rules should be applied before reporting:

- Order ID must be unique.
 - Required identifiers must not be blank.
 - Dates must follow the correct sequence.
 - Refund amounts cannot be negative.
 - Returns must reference a valid Order ID.
 - Refunds must reference the relevant order or return.
 - Status values should follow predefined business values.
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I. DATA USAGE

The data dictionary supports:

- Dashboard development
- KPI definition
- Data validation
- Requirement clarification
- UAT preparation
- Consistent communication between business and technical teams

J. KEY PRINCIPLE

One definition → One meaning → One consistent report

All teams should use the same field definitions and KPI logic to maintain consistency across operational and management reporting.